

# Austin Baldi

UX RESEARCHER

## CONTACT

ajonbaldi@gmail.com  
linkedin.com/in/austinbaldi  
austinbaldi.github.io  
Raleigh, NC  
calendly.com/ajonbaldi

## EDUCATION

**B.A. Psychology**  
NC State University

## PLAYTESTING

- Moderated & Unmoderated Playtests
- Think-Aloud Sessions
- Hypothesis-Anchored Study Design
- New Player Onboarding Research
- Genre-Unfamiliar Participant Testing
- Localization Audits

## ANALYSIS

- Frame-by-Frame Video Review
- Behavioral Pattern Recognition
- Cross-Session Synthesis
- Survey Design & Statistical Analysis
- Mixed-Methods Synthesis
- KPI Definition & Tracking

## TOOLS

- ffmpeg · ImageMagick · ReportLab
- Dovetail · UserTesting
- PlaytestCloud · Figma
- Notion · Zoom

## SUMMARY

UX researcher with 3+ years embedded in early-stage game development, running playtests and localization audits that reach dev teams the same day findings are ready. I work before problems calcify — identifying where players lose the thread, misread mechanics, or disengage, and delivering prioritized findings small teams can act on without slowing the sprint. Currently embedded with Eldritch House on an active Steam demo.

## RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

### UX Researcher · Independent Consultant

- Eldritch House (Brazil, Remote) — Shadow Sacrament: The Roots of Evil · DANGEN Entertainment · Nov 2025 – Present
- Embedded in an active indie studio (public Steam demo). Run iterative playtests across build cycles and deliver prioritized findings reports directly to the development team.
  - Flagged a pause menu default cursor position on a destructive action (Load Game rather than Resume): a finding that became a LinkedIn post reaching 18,000+ impressions.
  - Identified a 12-minute gap between lantern item acquisition and the game's activation tutorial, leaving players navigating dark areas without understanding how to use a core mechanic.
  - Ran a PT-BR localization audit across a 94-minute native speaker playthrough: 1,100+ frames extracted via a custom ffmpeg/ImageMagick pipeline, yielding 7 findings with timestamps and reproduction steps.
  - Identified a stealth visual feedback gap: the character model does not communicate a hidden state when crouching, causing players to misread detection as a bug rather than an intended mechanic.

### UX Researcher · Volunteer Contributor

- Kadena (Brooklyn, NY, Remote) — K-Block Blockchain Explorer · Oct 2022 – May 2024
- Designed and ran a 100+ respondent survey identifying where developers lost confidence during onboarding; follow-up evaluations measured roughly 25–30% improvement in comprehension after recommendations were implemented.
  - Mapped end-to-end developer workflows across 80–90% of common use cases; findings were used by product and engineering teams to restructure onboarding flows and surface previously buried features.

## PROJECTS

### Independent Games User Research Study — Disney Speedstorm (Gameloft)

- Games User Research Fundamentals · gamesuserresearch.com / PlaytestCloud · May 2024
- Identified recurring confusion around in-game currency and reward systems across 4 of 5 independent sessions — a cross-session pattern pointing to a systemic onboarding gap, not individual variance.
  - Ran 5 moderated think-aloud playtests with participants across 4 countries; designed the study, recruited participants, facilitated sessions, and synthesized findings independently without studio access or internal data.